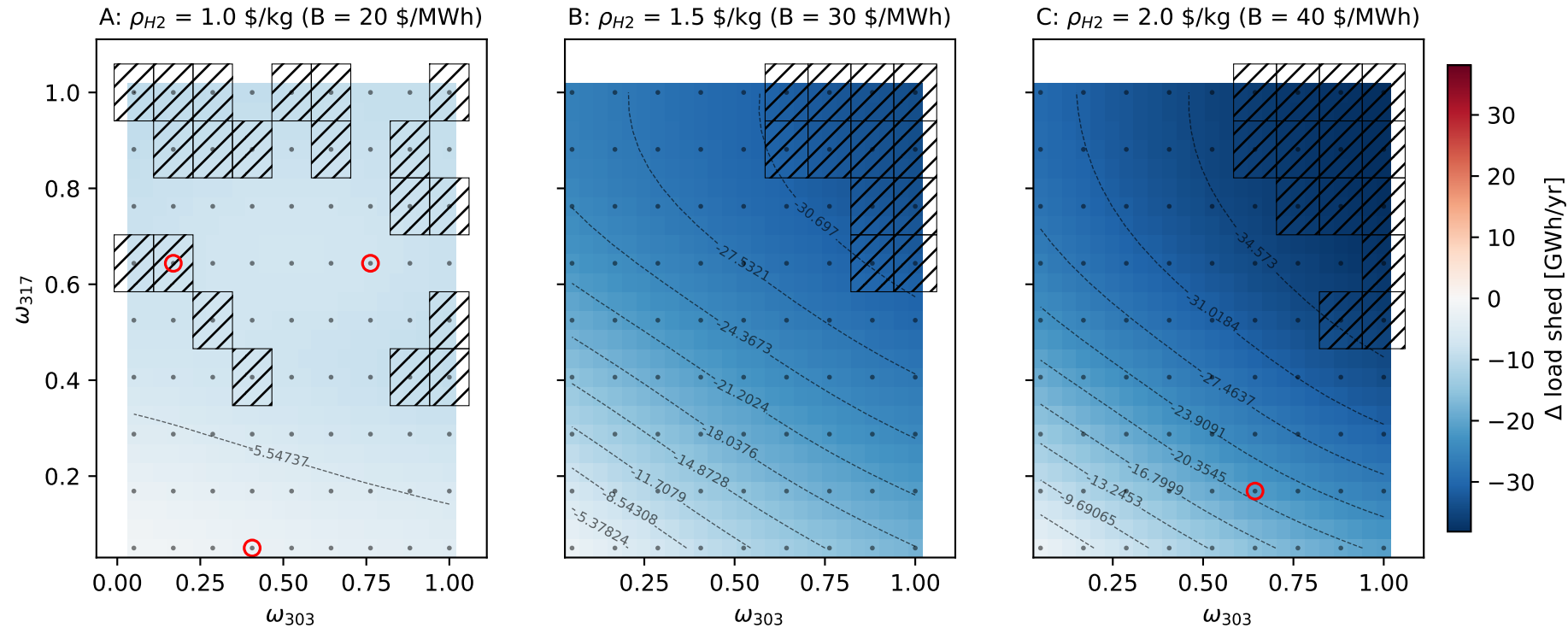


Δ load shed [GWh/yr] on the 303x317 pair grid (blue = improvement vs base)



GP posterior mean (Matern-2.5 ARD, per-surface standardization, fitted white noise) on 25x25; dots = 81 direct runs; open red circles = $|\text{observed} - \text{posterior mean}| > \text{noise floor}$. hatched: near-optimal set {cells $\leq$ grid min + floor} — a tie set, not a point optimum. Contour spacing $\geq$ floor.
 LOOCV (81-fold, per-fold standardization): A: $Q^2=0.59$, RMSE=1.73, flagged 3/81, near-opt tie set 20/81 cells; B: $Q^2=0.97$, RMSE=1.29, flagged 0/81, near-opt tie set 12/81 cells; C: $Q^2=0.98$, RMSE=1.17, flagged 1/81, near-opt tie set 14/81 cells